MODULE 8

Food for Thought

"You are what you eat."

— AMERICAN SAYING

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What can we do to make more healthful food choices?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Eco-Friendly Food**	· Cath Senker	INFORMATIONAL
2	**Kids Rock Nutrition in the Kitchen**	· from Nutrition.gov	COOKING VIDEO
3	**Bug Bites**	· Informational Text	INFORMATIONAL
4	**Now You're Cooking!**	· René Saldaña, Jr. (illus. Jonathan Allardyce)	REALISTIC FICTION

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A · Vocabulary (24) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 5

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 11

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 14

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 8 · Food for Thought · Grade 4 · 24 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

nutrition

If you have good **nutrition**, you —

- ◯ **A.** eat only the foods that taste the sweetest.
- ◯ **B.** skip meals so you do not gain weight.
- ◯ **C.** eat the right foods to help you stay healthy and grow.
- ◯ **D.** exercise hard but eat very little food.

Q2 L.4.6

digest

When you **digest** food, it —

- ◯ **A.** moves through your body and breaks down so you can use it.
- ◯ **B.** stays whole in your stomach without changing at all.
- ◯ **C.** grows larger the longer it sits inside you.
- ◯ **D.** turns straight back into the food you started with.

Q3 L.4.6 TRAP

sustainable

If a natural resource is **sustainable**, it —

- ◯ **A.** runs out very quickly and cannot be replaced.
- ◯ **B.** harms the environment a great deal.
- ◯ **C.** can stay at a certain level and not cause harm to the environment.
- ◯ **D.** can only be found deep underground.

Q4 L.4.6

compost

Compost is —

- ◯ **A.** a bag of seeds you plant in the spring.
- ◯ **B.** the fresh water you pour on a garden.
- ◯ **C.** the weeds you pull out of the soil.
- ◯ **D.** decayed plant waste that can be used to fertilize soil.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ECO-FRIENDLY FOOD

Q5 L.4.4

assess

The author says to **assess** yourself first. When you **assess** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** think about it carefully and judge it.
- ◯ **B.** accept it at once without a second thought.
- ◯ **C.** copy what someone else has already decided.
- ◯ **D.** guess about it quickly without really looking.

Q6 L.4.5 TRAP

disposable

A packed lunch may have many **disposable** items. If something is **disposable**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** meant to be used again and again for years.
- ◯ **B.** meant to be thrown away once it has been used.
- ◯ **C.** always made of metal.
- ◯ **D.** too valuable to ever use.

Q7 L.4.4

convenient

Pre-packaged meals are **convenient**. If something is **convenient**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** handy and useful.
- ◯ **B.** dirty and unsafe.
- ◯ **C.** hard to find and far away.
- ◯ **D.** heavy and slow to carry.

Q8 L.4.4

transported

Some food is packaged and **transported** across the country. If something is **transported**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** taken from one place to another.
- ◯ **B.** kept in one place and never moved.
- ◯ **C.** left to sit until it is needed.
- ◯ **D.** sent back to exactly where it started.

Q9 L.4.4

hydrated

Drinking tap water helps you stay **hydrated**. Something that is **hydrated** —

- ◯ **A.** has been left out in the sun to dry.
- ◯ **B.** has dried out and lost all its water.
- ◯ **C.** has taken in plenty of water.
- ◯ **D.** has been heated until it is completely dry.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ECO-FRIENDLY FOOD (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.4.4

impact

Our food choices have an **impact** on the planet. An **impact** is —

- ◯ **A.** the reason something first begins.
- ◯ **B.** the effect that one thing has on something else.
- ◯ **C.** a plan you make before you act.
- ◯ **D.** a choice that changes nothing at all.

Q11 L.4.5 TRAP

intensive

Some beans are grown by less energy-**intensive** methods. Something that is **intensive** —

- ◯ **A.** takes almost no effort at all.
- ◯ **B.** is very small and light.
- ◯ **C.** uses a lot of effort to complete a task.
- ◯ **D.** happens only once a year.

Q12 L.4.5 TRAP

adventurous

The video says to be **adventurous** and try new vegetables. Someone who is **adventurous** —

- ◯ **A.** is afraid to leave home.
- ◯ **B.** only eats the same food every day.
- ◯ **C.** refuses to taste anything new.
- ◯ **D.** tries to do new things.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · KIDS ROCK NUTRITION IN THE KITCHEN

Q13 L.4.4

unique

Each recipe in the video is **unique**. Something that is **unique** is —

- ◯ **A.** exactly the same as all the others.
- ◯ **B.** different or one of a kind.
- ◯ **C.** common and seen everywhere.
- ◯ **D.** just like a copy of another one.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · BUG BITES

Q14 L.4.4

pests

The article says bugs are not just **pests**. **Pests** are —

- ◯ **A.** insects or small animals that harm crops or annoy people.
- ◯ **B.** helpful insects that keep a garden healthy.
- ◯ **C.** tame animals that people keep as pets.
- ◯ **D.** tiny seeds that grow into crops.

Q15 L.4.4

edible

The article explains that many bugs are **edible**. If something is **edible**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** not safe to put in your mouth.
- ◯ **B.** safe for people to eat.
- ◯ **C.** poisonous if you swallow it.
- ◯ **D.** spoiled and no longer good to eat.

Q16 L.4.5 TRAP

forbidden

Some parts of the world have **forbidden** foods. If something is **forbidden**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** welcomed and encouraged.
- ◯ **B.** served at every meal.
- ◯ **C.** the most popular choice.
- ◯ **D.** not allowed or accepted.

Q17 L.4.4

attitudes

The article says **attitudes** about bugs are changing. Your **attitudes** are —

- ◯ **A.** the facts you have learned by heart.
- ◯ **B.** the ways you think and feel about something.
- ◯ **C.** the habits you do without thinking.
- ◯ **D.** the skills you practice over and over.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · NOW YOU'RE COOKING!

Q18 L.4.4

react

Avani waits to see how Martina will **react**. When you **react** to something, you —

- ◯ **A.** ignore it as if nothing happened.
- ◯ **B.** plan it out long before it happens.
- ◯ **C.** forget it the moment it is over.
- ◯ **D.** act in a way that shows you are aware of it.

Q19 L.4.5 TRAP

astounded

Martina is **astounded** that she made it to the finals. If you are **astounded**, you are —

- ◯ **A.** completely bored and uninterested.
- ◯ **B.** a little sleepy.
- ◯ **C.** completely surprised by something.
- ◯ **D.** not at all surprised.

Q20 L.4.4

luscious

The cooks prepare **luscious** dishes. A food that is **luscious** is —

- **A.** tasty and often juicy.
- **B.** dry and flavorless.
- **C.** old and spoiled.
- **D.** burnt and hard to chew.

Q21 L.4.4

culinary

Joey learns **culinary** skills at the restaurant. Something that is **culinary** is —

- **A.** connected to farming.
- **B.** connected to cleaning.
- **C.** connected to serving tables.
- **D.** connected to cooking.

Q22 L.4.4

offense

Joey tells Martina "no **offense**." An **offense** is —

- **A.** a kind word that cheers you up.
- **B.** something that makes you feel hurt, annoyed, or insulted.
- **C.** a polite way of saying thank you.
- **D.** a joke that everyone finds funny.

Q23 L.4.5 TRAP

crestfallen

After the cook-off, Martina was not **crestfallen**. If you are **crestfallen**, you are —

- **A.** cheerful and excited.
- **B.** proud and confident.
- **C.** sad and discouraged.
- **D.** wide awake and alert.

Q24 L.4.4

opted

Martina **opted** for olive oil instead of butter. If you **opted** for something, you —

- **A.** refused to take it.
- **B.** threw it away.
- **C.** forgot about it.
- **D.** chose it.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 8 · Food for Thought · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8 · RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Eco-Friendly Food

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · CATH SENKER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.4.2

What is "Eco-Friendly Food" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to bottle and sell water for a profit.
- ◯ **B.** Simple food and drink choices that are better for you and for the environment.
- ◯ **C.** Why pre-packaged organic meals are always the best choice.
- ◯ **D.** How to build the largest cylinder garden in the world.

Q2 RI.4.3

According to the text, what is the FIRST step toward a more eco-friendly lunch?

- ◯ **A.** Buy more pre-packaged snacks.
- ◯ **B.** Assess yourself to find out whether you are wasteful or waste-aware.
- ◯ **C.** Eat only at restaurants.
- ◯ **D.** Throw away all of your containers.

Q3 RI.4.8

The author claims that pre-packaged organic meals are not always better for the planet. Which reason in the article supports this claim?

- ◯ **A.** They taste better than fresh food.
- ◯ **B.** They are always more colorful.
- ◯ **C.** They are packaged, transported, and often chilled, which uses energy and creates waste.
- ◯ **D.** They are sold only in winter.

Q4 RI.4.3

What surprising fact does the author share about bottled water?

- **A.** It is always cleaner than tap water.
- **B.** It is free in most stores.
- **C.** It can never be recycled.
- **D.** About half of it is really tap water, yet it can cost 100 times as much.

Q5 RI.4.3

According to the text, why is cylinder gardening a good idea for a school?

- **A.** It needs expensive machines.
- **B.** It only works in the winter.
- **C.** It requires a very large field.
- **D.** It is a cheap and easy way to grow food using containers that can be placed almost anywhere.

Q6 RI.4.5

The author organizes the "Make a Cylinder Garden" part of the text as a series of numbered steps. Why does the author use this text structure?

- **A.** To list the names of famous gardeners.
- **B.** To show the reader the order in which to do each part of the project.
- **C.** To compare two different cities.
- **D.** To tell a make-believe story.

Q7 RI.4.6

What is the author's main purpose for writing "Eco-Friendly Food"?

- **A.** To make the reader laugh with silly jokes.
- **B.** To tell about the author's own childhood.
- **C.** To sell bottled water to readers.
- **D.** To inform readers about choices that make food healthier and better for the environment.

Q8 RI.4.2

Which sentence best states a CENTRAL IDEA of the selection?

- **A.** Small, everyday choices can make food healthier, cheaper, and better for the environment.
- **B.** Pre-packaged organic snacks are always the best choice for the planet.
- **C.** Buying bottled water is the safest way to stay healthy and hydrated each day.
- **D.** Only farmers with a large field are able to grow their own healthful food.

Selection 2 · Kids Rock Nutrition in the Kitchen

COOKING VIDEO · FROM NUTRITION.GOV · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.4.2

What is the cooking video "Kids Rock Nutrition in the Kitchen" mostly about?

- **A.** How to win a cooking contest on television.
- **B.** Why kitchens should be painted bright colors.
- **C.** How to grow vegetables in a garden.
- **D.** How to prepare tasty, nutritious meals and make healthful food choices.

Q10 RI.4.3

Which three recipes are prepared in the video?

- **A.** Pizza, soup, and cookies.
- **B.** Chicken pockets, fish pockets, and fruit parfaits.
- **C.** Pancakes, eggs, and toast.
- **D.** Tacos, beans, and rice.

Q11 RI.4.3

According to the video, how long must chicken bake to be fully cooked and safe to eat?

- **A.** About two minutes.
- **B.** A full day.
- **C.** About 20 minutes, until it reaches 165 degrees F.
- **D.** It never needs to be cooked.

Q12 RI.4.6

In a recipe video, what is the main job of the narrator?

- **A.** To sell pots and pans to viewers.
- **B.** To tell a funny made-up story.
- **C.** To introduce the ingredients and explain and show the steps of the recipe.
- **D.** To sing songs while others cook.

Q13 RI.4.5

Besides the narrator's voice, what feature do recipe videos often use to help viewers follow along?

- **A.** A price tag showing how much each food costs.
- **B.** A clock counting down the minutes until the show ends.
- **C.** Text on the screen that shows ingredients and describes the steps.
- **D.** A list of other videos to watch next.

Q14 RI.4.3

According to the video, why is it a good idea to try different vegetables?

- **A.** Because vegetables are always the cheapest food.
- **B.** Because vegetables never need to be washed.
- **C.** Because they can be eaten without cooking them.
- **D.** Because being adventurous and trying new vegetables is part of eating well when you want a change.

Q15 RI.4.2

What is one main message viewers can take from the video?

- **A.** Kids can help prepare healthful, tasty meals in the kitchen.
- **B.** Only grown-ups are allowed to cook food in the kitchen.
- **C.** Cooking a meal takes far too long to ever be worth it.
- **D.** Food that is healthful for you almost always tastes bad.

Q16 RI.4.6

Why does Nutrition.gov, a government website, share a video like this one?

- **A.** To teach families how to make healthful food choices and prepare nutritious meals.
- **B.** To advertise a brand of frozen dinners.
- **C.** To show that cooking is too dangerous for kids.
- **D.** To prove that only chefs can make good food.

Selection 3 · Bug Bites

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.4.2

What is "Bug Bites" mostly about?

- **A.** Eating insects around the world and why bugs can be a nutritious food.
- **B.** Why people should be afraid of all insects.
- **C.** How to raise crickets and termites to sell as pets.
- **D.** How to keep pests out of a garden.

Q18 RI.4.3

According to the text, how do many people around the world think of bugs?

- **A.** Only as pets to keep in a cage.
- **B.** As lunch, dinner, or a nice afterschool snack — not just as pests.
- **C.** As something that should never be touched.
- **D.** As a kind of money.

Q19 RI.4.8

The author claims that bugs are a healthful food. Which detail in the article BEST supports this claim?

- ◯ **A.** A pound of grasshoppers has less fat than a pound of beef and is higher in calcium and iron.
- ◯ **B.** Bugs come in many colors.
- ◯ **C.** Bugs can fly and crawl.
- ◯ **D.** Bugs are easy to catch.

Q20 RI.4.3

Which example shows that foods many people DO eat are still "bug-related"?

- ◯ **A.** Bread is baked in an oven.
- ◯ **B.** Milk comes from cows.
- ◯ **C.** Honey is made by bees, and shrimp, crayfish, crabs, and lobsters are all arthropods.
- ◯ **D.** Apples grow on trees.

Q21 RI.4.5

The author uses headings such as "Bugs Do a Body Good" and "Future Food." How do these headings help the reader?

- ◯ **A.** They tell the reader what each part of the article will be about.
- ◯ **B.** They give the price of each food.
- ◯ **C.** They list the author's friends.
- ◯ **D.** They rhyme to make a song.

Q22 RI.4.6

The article opens with a joke about a fly in a customer's soup. Why does the author begin this way?

- ◯ **A.** To warn readers never to eat soup.
- ◯ **B.** To explain how to cook soup.
- ◯ **C.** To catch the reader's interest in a light, humorous way before sharing facts about eating bugs.
- ◯ **D.** To tell a sad story.

Q23 RI.4.3

According to the text, why might bugs be a good food for long space journeys?

- ◯ **A.** Because they can fly in space.
- ◯ **B.** Because they glow in the dark.
- ◯ **C.** Because they do not need any air.
- ◯ **D.** Because they are nutritious and considered a perfect food, so they could feed astronauts.

Q24 RI.4.2

Which sentence best states the CENTRAL IDEA of "Bug Bites"?

- ◯ **A.** Bugs are dangerous and should be feared.
- ◯ **B.** Insects are a nutritious, sustainable food eaten around the world, and what counts as food is a matter of taste and culture.
- ◯ **C.** Only people in other countries eat insects.
- ◯ **D.** Bugs are always the cheapest food to buy.

Selection 4 · Now You're Cooking!

REALISTIC FICTION · RENÉ SALDAÑA, JR. (ILLUS. JONATHAN ALLARDYCE) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "Now You're Cooking!" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to open a restaurant in a new town.
- ◯ **B.** A girl named Martina who competes in a cook-off and finds inspiration in her own family's recipe.
- ◯ **C.** A real history of Mexican cooking.
- ◯ **D.** A boy who learns to ride a bicycle.

Q26 RL.4.3

At the start of the story, why is Martina so nervous about the Spring Cook-Off?

- ◯ **A.** She has cooked in many contests before.
- ◯ **B.** She does not want to win.
- ◯ **C.** She forgot to sign up.
- ◯ **D.** She is a finalist, but her experience in the kitchen had been limited to pouring milk on her cereal.

Q27 RL.4.3

How is Joey Cardenas different from Martina as a competitor?

- ◯ **A.** He has never cooked before either.
- ◯ **B.** He refuses to enter the cook-off.
- ◯ **C.** His mother owns the best Mexican restaurant in town, and he learned to cook from its chef.
- ◯ **D.** He cooks only desserts.

Q28 RL.4.3

What finally gives Martina an idea for her dish?

- ◯ **A.** She remembers her abuelito Servando teaching her to fix his favorite breakfast.
- ◯ **B.** She copies Joey's recipe.
- ◯ **C.** She buys a meal from a store.
- ◯ **D.** She picks a dish at random.

Q29 RL.4.3

How does Martina act when she loses the cook-off to Joey?

- ◯ **A.** She refuses to speak to anyone.
- ◯ **B.** She blames her friend Avani.
- ◯ **C.** She quits cooking forever.
- ◯ **D.** She is gracious, congratulates Joey, and tells him he cooked a better meal.

Q30 RL.4.6

"Now You're Cooking!" is told in third-person point of view. What does this mean?

- ◯ **A.** The story is told by an outside observer who calls the characters "she," "he," and by name.
- ◯ **B.** Martina tells the story using the word "I."
- ◯ **C.** The reader writes the ending.
- ◯ **D.** The story has no narrator at all.

Q31 RL.4.5

"Now You're Cooking!" is realistic fiction. Which feature shows that it belongs to this genre?

- ◯ **A.** It gives true facts about real scientists.
- ◯ **B.** It tells a made-up story about characters who act, think, and speak like real people.
- ◯ **C.** It uses rhyme on every line.
- ◯ **D.** It lists steps for a science experiment.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main THEME, or lesson, of "Now You're Cooking!"?

- ◯ **A.** Martina's friend is named Avani.
- ◯ **B.** The cook-off is held in the spring.
- ◯ **C.** Believe in yourself and draw on what makes you unique — doing your best and being gracious matter more than winning.
- ◯ **D.** Joey's mother owns a restaurant.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 8 · Food for Thought · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how we can make more healthful food choices. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Eco-Friendly Food,"** the author shows simple choices that are better for you and the planet. Show WHAT problem the author points out, then explain HOW we can make better choices and what it teaches.

CHOICES FOR A HEALTHIER PLANET · ECO-FRIENDLY FOOD

THE PROBLEM	A BETTER CHOICE	WHY IT MATTERS

The author says to assess yourself first — are you wasteful or waste-aware? Why is taking responsibility for small, everyday choices (like tap water or a cylinder garden) so powerful? Explain.

Q2 Connection DOK 3

In **"Bug Bites,"** the author argues that insects are a nutritious, sustainable food. Show WHAT makes bugs healthful, then explain HOW eating them connects food to the wider world.

FOOD IS CONNECTED · BUG BITES

WHY BUGS ARE HEALTHFUL	A CONNECTION	FUTURE FOOD
what does the text say?	*how do bugs link to other food?*	*why might bugs matter later?*

The text compares a pound of grasshoppers to a pound of beef. Why does seeing food as part of a larger system help us make more sustainable choices? Explain.

Q3 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Bug Bites,"** the author says what counts as food is "a matter of taste — and what you've been taught." Compare TWO different points of view, then explain the lesson.

DIFFERENT POINTS OF VIEW · BUG BITES

ONE VIEW OF EATING BUGS	ANOTHER VIEW OF EATING BUGS

In some places eating bugs is normal; in others it seems strange. Why is it important to understand that people from different cultures can see the same food in different ways? Explain.

Q4 Change DOK 3

In **"Now You're Cooking!,"** Martina makes a choice that changes her dish and herself. Show the CHOICE she makes, then explain the CHANGE it brings and the lesson it teaches.

A CHOICE THAT BRINGS CHANGE · NOW YOU'RE COOKING!

MARTINA'S CHOICE	WHAT CHANGES

Martina stops copying TV chefs and chooses her grandfather's healthful recipe. Why can one small choice change how we feel about ourselves? Use the word *change* in your answer.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: What can we do to make more healthful food choices? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What does this selection teach about healthful food choices?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What does this selection teach about healthful food choices?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 8 · Food for Thought · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Three Sisters Garden

Long ago, many Native American farmers planted three crops together in the same field: corn, beans, and squash. They called these crops the "Three Sisters." Each plant helped the others grow, the way good sisters help one another. First, the farmers planted the corn. As the corn grew tall and strong, its stalk became a pole. Next, they planted beans at the foot of the corn. The bean vines climbed up the corn stalk, so they did not need a wooden stick to hold them. The beans also put something good into the soil that helped the corn grow. Last, the farmers planted squash. The wide, flat squash leaves spread out over the ground like a blanket. This blanket of leaves kept the soil cool and wet, and it stopped weeds from growing. Together, the Three Sisters gave the people a healthful meal. Corn, beans, and squash eaten together give the body almost everything it needs. Even today, gardeners plant the Three Sisters to grow food in a way that is good for people and good for the soil.

179 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 · Lexile 500L · Key Detail

Which three crops make up the "Three Sisters"?

- ◯ **A.** Apples, peas, and rice.
- ◯ **B.** Wheat, carrots, and corn.
- ◯ **C.** Corn, beans, and squash.
- ◯ **D.** Tomatoes, beans, and onions.

Q2 RIT 202 · Lexile 520L · Key Detail

Which crop do the farmers plant FIRST?

- ◯ **A.** The corn.
- ◯ **B.** The squash.
- ◯ **C.** The beans.
- ◯ **D.** The weeds.

Q3 RIT 203 · Lexile 530L · Cause & Effect

Why do the bean vines NOT need a wooden stick to hold them up?

- ◯ **A.** The squash holds them up.
- ◯ **B.** The farmers tie them with rope.
- ◯ **C.** They grow flat along the ground.
- ◯ **D.** They climb up the tall corn stalk instead.

Q4 RIT 205 · Lexile 550L · Cause & Effect

How do the wide squash leaves help the garden?

- ◯ **A.** They feed the birds.
- ◯ **B.** They keep the soil cool and wet and stop weeds from growing.
- ◯ **C.** They climb the corn.
- ◯ **D.** They make the corn taller.

Q5 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Main Idea

What is this passage MOSTLY about?

- ◯ **A.** How planting corn, beans, and squash together grows healthful food and helps the soil.
- ◯ **B.** How to cook a squash for dinner.
- ◯ **C.** Why corn grows taller than beans.
- ◯ **D.** How farmers sell crops at a market.

Passage 2 · The Lunchbox Letter

On Monday morning, Maya found a note tucked inside her lunchbox. It was from her older brother, Theo. "Try a no-waste lunch this week," the note said. "I bet you can do it!" Maya looked at her lunch. Her sandwich was wrapped in plastic. Her apple slices were in a plastic bag, and her juice came in a small box with a tiny straw. After lunch, she counted four pieces of trash in the bin. The next day, Maya made a change. She packed her sandwich in a metal container that she could use again. She brought a whole apple instead of sliced apple in a bag. Instead of a juice box, she filled a reusable bottle with water from the tap at home. At the end of lunch, there was nothing to throw away — not a single wrapper. By Friday, the whole table had noticed. Two of Maya's friends started bringing reusable bottles too. "Your brother had a good idea," one friend said. Maya smiled. A small change in her lunchbox had grown into something bigger, and it had started with one little note.

185 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

Who leaves the note in Maya's lunchbox?

- ◯ **A.** Her teacher.
- ◯ **B.** Her best friend.
- ◯ **C.** Her mother.
- ◯ **D.** Her older brother, Theo.

Q7 RIT 208 · Lexile 580L · Key Detail

What does Maya use instead of a juice box?

- ◯ **A.** A plastic bag.
- ◯ **B.** A reusable bottle filled with tap water.
- ◯ **C.** A paper cup.
- ◯ **D.** A glass jar of milk.

Q8 RIT 209 · Lexile 590L · Cause & Effect

What happens to Maya's trash after she changes her lunch?

- ◯ **A.** There is nothing to throw away — not a single wrapper.
- ◯ **B.** It grows to six pieces.
- ◯ **C.** It stays the same as before.
- ◯ **D.** It is mostly plastic.

Q9 RIT 210 · Lexile 600L · Inference

Why do two of Maya's friends start bringing reusable bottles?

- ◯ **A.** Their teacher made a rule about it.
- ◯ **B.** They ran out of juice boxes.
- ◯ **C.** They saw Maya's no-waste lunch and were inspired to try it too.
- ◯ **D.** They wanted to copy Theo.

Q10 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Main Idea

What is the main lesson of "The Lunchbox Letter"?

- ◯ **A.** Plastic bags are the easiest way to pack a lunch.
- ◯ **B.** One small change can grow into something bigger and help others make better choices too.
- ◯ **C.** Juice tastes better than water.
- ◯ **D.** Notes should always be written by a brother.

Passage 3 · How Honey Is Made

Have you ever wondered where honey comes from? It begins with flowers and a busy little insect: the honeybee. On a warm day, a worker bee flies from flower to flower. With a long, tube-like tongue, it sips a sweet liquid called nectar from deep inside each blossom. The bee stores the nectar in a special pouch in its body, almost like a tiny stomach made just for carrying nectar. When the pouch is full, the bee flies back to the hive. Inside the hive, the worker bee passes the nectar to other bees. They chew it and pass it along again and again. Slowly, the nectar changes and becomes thicker. The bees place this thick liquid into small wax rooms called honeycombs. But the honey is still too watery. To dry it, the bees beat their wings fast, fanning the honeycomb like hundreds of tiny fans. The moving air dries the honey until it is thick and sticky. At last, the bees cover each filled cell with a thin cap of wax to keep the honey fresh. One little jar of honey is the work of thousands of bees and millions of flowers.

194 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

What sweet liquid does the worker bee sip from inside each flower?

- **A.** Water.
- **B.** Nectar.
- **C.** Milk.
- **D.** Juice.

Q12 RIT 212 · Lexile 640L · Key Detail

Where do the bees store the thick liquid inside the hive?

- **A.** In a glass jar.
- **B.** In the flowers.
- **C.** In a pouch on a flower.
- **D.** In small wax rooms called honeycombs.

Q13 RIT 213 · Lexile 660L · Cause & Effect

Why do the bees beat their wings fast over the honeycomb?

- **A.** They are trying to fly away.
- **B.** They want to cool the flowers.
- **C.** The moving air dries the watery honey until it is thick.
- **D.** They are washing the nectar.

Q14 RIT 215 · Lexile 680L · Vocabulary

The passage says the bee "sips" nectar from each blossom. In this sentence, **sips** means —

- **A.** drinks a little at a time.
- **B.** throws it away.
- **C.** plants it in the ground.
- **D.** paints it on a wall.

Q15 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "How Honey Is Made"?

- ◯ **A.** Honey is sold in stores.
- ◯ **B.** Bees live together in a hive.
- ◯ **C.** Flowers smell sweet in the spring.
- ◯ **D.** Making honey is a long, careful process that takes thousands of bees and millions of flowers.

Passage 4 · The Boy Who Would Not Eat His Greens

There once was a boy named Otis who would not eat anything green. He pushed away his peas. He hid his broccoli under his fork. He shook his head at every leaf of lettuce. "Greens are for rabbits," he said. One spring, Otis's grandmother gave him a small packet of seeds and a pot of soil. "These are yours to grow," she told him. "Water them every morning, and let them have plenty of sun." Otis was curious, so he did as she asked. Each day he watched the soil. After a week, a tiny green shoot pushed up through the dirt. Otis was amazed that something so small had come from him. The shoot grew into a leafy plant, and soon it was full of crisp green leaves. "What is it?" Otis asked. "Spinach," said his grandmother, smiling. "The very thing you would not eat." That night, Otis tried one leaf from his own plant. To his surprise, it tasted fresh and good — far better than the greens he had refused before. From then on, Otis ate his greens, especially the ones he grew himself. Sometimes, he learned, the best way to like a food is to grow it with your own hands.

204 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Key Detail

At the start of the story, how does Otis feel about green food?

- ◯ **A.** He refuses to eat anything green.
- ◯ **B.** It is his favorite.
- ◯ **C.** He eats it only at night.
- ◯ **D.** He grows it in a garden.

Q17 RIT 217 · Lexile 720L · Key Detail

What does Otis's grandmother give him?

- ◯ **A.** A plate of broccoli.
- ◯ **B.** A new fork.
- ◯ **C.** A packet of seeds and a pot of soil.
- ◯ **D.** A pet rabbit.

Q18 RIT 218 Lexile 740L Cause & Effect

What happens after Otis waters the seeds for a week?

- **A.** The seeds wash away.
- **B.** A tiny green shoot pushes up through the dirt.
- **C.** The pot breaks.
- **D.** Nothing grows at all.

Q19 RIT 219 Lexile 770L Vocabulary

The story says Otis was "amazed that something so small had come from him." The word **amazed** means —

- **A.** bored and tired.
- **B.** angry and upset.
- **C.** fast asleep.
- **D.** filled with wonder and surprise.

Q20 RIT 220 Lexile 800L Main Idea

What is the lesson, or theme, of this story?

- **A.** Rabbits like to eat lettuce.
- **B.** Spinach grows quickly in a pot.
- **C.** Sometimes the best way to like a food is to grow it yourself — and to keep an open mind.
- **D.** Grandmothers know a lot about plants.